STAMPEDE

Functional Specification

User Signup & Onboarding

v1.0 | March 2025 | CONFIDENTIAL

Field	Value
Feature	User Signup & Onboarding Flow
Parent PRD	Stampede Circles PRD v3.0
CLAUDE.md Section	Phase 1 — Foundation (Step 2: Auth endpoints)
Status	Ready for Development
Owner	Product Team
Version	1.0

1. Overview

This document specifies the exact behavior of the Stampede user signup and onboarding flow. It covers every screen, every field, every validation rule, every error state, and every edge case. Engineers and AI coding agents should treat this as the definitive source of truth for building the signup experience.

Signup in Stampede is not a standard email/password form. It is a 6-step onboarding journey that builds a fan's musical identity from the first interaction — collecting personality type, role, subscription tier, and Circle preferences before the user reaches the main app.

Design Principle: Every step of signup should feel like it's building toward something meaningful — not collecting data for the platform. Frame each step as identity discovery, not form filling.

2. Entry Points

The signup flow can be entered from multiple contexts. The entry point affects Step 5 (Circle Discovery) and the post-completion destination.

Entry Point	How Triggered	Effect on Flow
App launch (unauthenticated)	User opens app with no session	Standard flow; Circle Discovery shows top recommended Circles
Join Circle button	Unauthenticated user taps Join on a Circle	Standard flow; Step 5 shows that specific Circle first
Invite link	Member shares a Circle invite URL	Standard flow; Step 5 auto-selects the inviting Circle; show inviter name
Artist profile	Unauthenticated user views an artist page	Standard flow; Step 5 shows Circles containing that artist
Deep link (rodeo)	Link to a specific rodeo	Standard flow; after completion, redirect to that rodeo

Rule: If a user with an existing account attempts signup, detect the duplicate email at Step 1 and redirect to login — never create a duplicate account.

3. Flow Overview

The signup flow is a 6-step sequential wizard. Users cannot skip steps unless explicitly noted. Progress is preserved in session storage so returning users resume where they left off.

Step	Screen Name	Required	Skippable	Description
1	Email & Password	Yes	No	Create account credentials
2	Email Verification	Yes	No	Verify email address
3	Profile Setup	Yes	No	Display name, avatar, role selection
4	Subscription Tier	Yes	No	Choose Free, Fan, or Superfan tier
5	Personality Quiz	Yes	Yes	Select top 3 personality types (Stampede-specific)
6	Circle Discovery	Yes	Yes	Join a Circle or browse; completes onboarding

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4. Step-by-Step Behavioral Specification

Step 1 — Email & Password

UI Elements

- Stampede logo + tagline: "The home of country music"
- Email field (type=email, autocomplete=email)
- Password field (type=password, show/hide toggle)
- Password strength meter (4 levels: Weak / Fair / Good / Strong)
- "Create Account" primary button (disabled until fields valid)
- "Already have an account? Log in" link
- Social sign-in options: Continue with Apple, Continue with Google (future — mark [OPEN])

Validation Rules

Field	Rule	Error Message
Email	Valid email format (RFC 5322)	Please enter a valid email address
Email	Not already registered	An account with this email exists. Log in instead →
Password	Minimum 8 characters	Password must be at least 8 characters
Password	At least 1 number	Password must include at least one number
Password	At least 1 special character (!@#$%^&*)	Password must include at least one special character

Password	Not a common password (check against top-1000 list)	This password is too common. Please choose a stronger one

Interactions

- **Email blur**: validate format inline; do NOT check for existing account until submit (avoids account enumeration)
- **Password keyup**: update strength meter in real time; show requirements checklist below field
- **Submit**: validate all fields; if valid → call POST /auth/register; on success → go to Step 2
- **Existing email detected**: show inline message with login link; do NOT reveal whether the account uses social sign-in

Success State

✓ **Success:** Account created (unverified). Verification email sent. Advance to Step 2 automatically.

Error States

✗ **Error:** Network error on submit → show toast: "Something went wrong. Please try again." Retain form values.

✗ **Error:** Rate limit hit (5 accounts per IP per hour) → show: "Too many accounts created. Please try again later."

Backend Actions

- Create User record with status='unverified'
- Generate email verification token (UUID, expires 24 hours)
- Send verification email (template: 'Verify your Stampede account')
- Store partial signup state in session (step=2)

Step 2 — Email Verification

UI Elements

- Heading: "Check your inbox"
- Subtext: "We sent a verification link to [email]. Click it to continue."
- "Resend email" button (disabled for 60 seconds after send, shows countdown)
- "Change email address" link (returns to Step 1, clears password)
- Animation: subtle pulsing envelope icon

Verification Link Behavior

- **User clicks link in email**: token validated server-side → mark User email_verified=true → redirect to app → resume at Step 3
- **Token expired (>24 hours)**: show screen: "This link has expired. Request a new one." with Resend button
- **Token already used**: show screen: "This link has already been used. Log in instead." with login link
- **Token not found**: show generic error; do not reveal whether token existed

Resend Rules

Rule: Resend is rate-limited to once per 60 seconds per session, and max 5 resends per email address per hour. After 5 resends, show: "Too many attempts. Please try again in an hour."

Edge Cases

- User closes the app after Step 1 and reopens — show Step 2 screen again (resume from session)
- User verifies on a different device — the original device should detect verification on next app focus (poll /auth/verify-status every 5 seconds while Step 2 is active)
- User changes email — invalidate old verification token; create new User record with new email; resend

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Step 3 — Profile Setup

UI Elements

- Avatar upload area (tap to upload; shows preview; default is generated initials avatar)
- Display name field (text, 3–60 chars)
- Real-time availability indicator (✓ Available / ✗ Taken) — debounced 400ms
- Role selector — three cards with icon + description:
  - Fan — "I love country music and want to discover, rate, and support artists"
  - Artist — "I create country music and want to manage my career and connect with fans"
  - Producer / Circle Founder — "I want to create and run music communities"
- "Continue" button (disabled until display_name valid and role selected)

Validation Rules

Field	Rule	Error Message
Display name	3–60 characters	Name must be between 3 and 60 characters
Display name	Only letters, numbers,	Only letters, numbers, _ and - are allowed

	underscores, hyphens	
Display name	Not already taken	That name is taken — try another
Avatar	JPG or PNG only	Please upload a JPG or PNG image
Avatar	Max 5MB	Image must be under 5MB
Role	One must be selected	Please select your role to continue

Role Effects

The role selected here sets User.subscription_tier defaults and affects which screens are shown in later steps:

- **Fan**: Default tier = 'free'; Step 4 shows Fan and Superfan options
- **Artist**: Default tier = 'artist'; Step 4 shows Artist subscription options; skip personality quiz (still offered as optional)
- **Producer**: Default tier = 'producer'; Step 4 shows Producer subscription; personality quiz shown as optional

Avatar Behavior

- If no avatar uploaded: generate a branded initials avatar (first letter of display_name on ORANGE background)
- Upload: crop to square, resize to max 400x400px on client before upload
- Store in object storage; save URL to User.avatar_url

Step 4 — Subscription Tier

UI Elements

- Heading: "Choose how you want to experience Stampede"
- 3 tier cards side-by-side (or stacked on mobile): Free / Fan / Superfan
- Each card shows: name, price, feature list, CTA button
- "Most Popular" badge on Fan tier
- Toggle: Monthly / Annual (annual shows savings percentage)
- For paid tiers: payment form appears inline after selection (Stripe Elements)
- "Skip for now" link below cards (sets tier to 'free', advances to Step 5)

Tier Feature Comparison

Feature	Free	Fan	Superfan
Join Circles	✓ (read only)	✓ Full access	✓ Full access
Vote in Rodeos	✗	✓	✓
Nomination Budget	✗	3 slots/period	3 slots/period + priority

Send Gifts & Tips	✗	✓	✓
Board Eligibility	✗	✗	✓
Circle Creation	✗	✗	✓ (Producer tier)
Price	Free	$X/month	$Y/month

Rule: Pricing values $X and $Y are [OPEN] — set by business team. Render from config, never hardcode in UI.

Payment Flow (Paid Tiers)

1. User selects Fan or Superfan tier
2. Payment form expands inline (Stripe Elements: card number, expiry, CVC, ZIP)
3. User submits → create Stripe Customer + Subscription → on success → advance to Step 5
4. Payment failure → show Stripe error message inline; do not advance

✗ Error: Card declined → show Stripe's decline message (e.g., "Your card was declined.") with option to try a different card.

✗ Error: 3D Secure required → open Stripe's 3DS modal; handle success/failure within modal.

Free Tier Path

User clicks "Skip for now" or selects Free → no payment required → advance to Step 5 immediately. User can upgrade at any time from their profile.

Step 5 — Personality Quiz

Overview

Inspired by Myers-Briggs and 16Personalities frameworks. The quiz helps Stampede understand a fan's musical identity and match them to the right Circles. Results seed the initial Circle recommendation engine.

UI Elements

- Progress indicator: "Question X of 5"
- One question per screen (swipeable forward/back)
- Each question has 4 answer options as large tap cards
- Selected answer highlighted in ORANGE; user can change before advancing
- "Skip this quiz" link (bottom of every question screen)

- Final screen: personality type summary card + "Your top 3 types" selection

Questions

#	Question	Options
1	When a song hits you, what hits first?	The lyrics / The melody / The instrumentation / The feeling it gives me
2	How do you discover new music?	I hunt for hours / Friends share it with me / I stumble onto it / I stick to what I know
3	Your perfect country music moment is:	Live at a small venue / Driving alone on a highway / Sitting around a fire / A packed stadium
4	What matters most in a country artist?	Their story / Their voice / Their live show / Their authenticity
5	How do you feel about emerging artists?	I love finding them early / I prefer proven talent / I follow wherever the music leads / Mix of both

Personality Type Assignment

Based on answers, Stampede assigns the user a primary personality type. User then sees their top 3 types and can adjust. Types are drawn from a predefined taxonomy (to be defined in coordination with Circle persona design).

> **Rule:** [OPEN] — Personality type taxonomy and answer-to-type mapping algorithm to be defined. For v1, present all available types and let user self-select their top 3 directly.

Skip Behavior

- If user skips: store personality_types = [] on User record
- Circle matching falls back to: popularity-based recommendations for the user's region
- User can complete the quiz later from their profile ("Complete your music identity")

Storage

- Store selected types as User.personality_types (string array, max 3 items)
- Pass types to Circle recommendation engine immediately after step completes

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Step 6 — Circle Discovery

UI Elements

- Heading: "Find your community"
- Subheading: "Join a Circle to start discovering music with people who hear it like you do"
- If entry via invite link: show inviting Circle as first card with inviter name ("[Name] invited you")

- 3–5 recommended Circle cards based on personality type results
- Each Circle card shows: name, core artists, member count, avg song rating, "Join" button
- "Browse all Circles" link (opens full Circle list)
- "Skip for now" link (completes onboarding without joining)
- "Done" button after joining at least one Circle

Join Behavior

- **User taps Join**: creates CircleMember record with status='active', role='member'; shows confirmation tick on card
- **Multiple joins allowed**: user can join more than one Circle from this screen
- **Circle at max pending**: show "Applications full — check back soon" instead of Join button
- **Paid Circle join**: show subscription gate if user is on Free tier

Completion

- **Joined at least 1 Circle**: show celebration screen: "You're in! Welcome to [Circle name]." → navigate to CircleDashboardScreen
- **Skipped all Circles**: show: "You can join a Circle anytime from the Explore tab." → navigate to home feed
- **Arrived via rodeo deep link**: navigate to that specific RodeoScreen after completion

Post-Completion Actions

- Send welcome email (template: 'Welcome to Stampede')
- If Circle joined: notify Circle board "New member joined" (per notification spec)
- Set User.signup_completed_at = now()
- Clear signup session state

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5. Global Rules Across All Steps

5.1 Progress Persistence

- Signup progress is stored in encrypted session storage keyed by device
- If user closes app mid-flow and returns within 48 hours: resume from last completed step
- After 48 hours of inactivity: clear session; restart from Step 1 (email pre-filled if browser autofill available)
- Verified email step cannot be re-entered once passed

5.2 Back Navigation

- All steps support back navigation except Step 2 (email verification) → Step 1 (going back to Step 1 would require re-entering email/password, instead offer "Change email" link)
- Going back does not clear already-entered data
- Going back from Step 4 (if paid tier selected) cancels any pending Stripe PaymentIntent

5.3 Rate Limits

Action	Limit	Reset
Account creation per IP	5 per hour	Rolling 60-min window
Verification email resend	5 per email per hour	Rolling 60-min window
Display name availability check	30 per minute	Rolling 60-sec window
Login attempts	10 per IP per 15 min	Rolling 15-min window

5.4 Accessibility

- All form fields have visible labels (no placeholder-only labeling)
- Error messages are associated with their field via aria-describedby
- Step progress indicator includes aria-label "Step X of 6"
- Keyboard navigation: Tab through fields; Enter submits current step
- Password show/hide button has aria-label "Show password" / "Hide password"
- Color is never the sole indicator of state (errors use icon + text + color)

5.5 Analytics Events

Fire the following events at each step transition (analytics system TBD):

Event Name	Trigger	Properties
signup_started	Step 1 renders	entry_point, device_type
signup_step_completed	Each step advances	step_number, step_name, time_on_step_secs
signup_email_verified	Email token validated	time_since_registration_secs
signup_role_selected	Role chosen in Step 3	role
signup_tier_selected	Tier chosen in Step 4	tier, billing_period
signup_quiz_completed	Step 5 completed	skipped (bool), types_selected
signup_circle_joined	Circle joined in Step 6	circle_id, entry_point
signup_completed	Step 6 dismissed	circles_joined_count, total_time_secs
signup_abandoned	App closed mid-flow	last_step_completed

6. Permissions Matrix

Action	Unauthenticated	Free	Fan	Superfan	Artist	Producer
Create account	✓	—	—	—	—	—
View Circles (read)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Join a Circle	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Vote in Rodeos	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Send gifts/tips	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Nominate Young Bucks	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Serve on Circle board	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓
Create a Circle	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓

7. Notifications Triggered

Trigger	Recipient	Channel	Template
Step 1 complete	User	Email	verify-email
Step 6 complete	User	Email + Push	welcome
Circle joined	Circle board	In-app	new-member-joined
Invite link used	Inviter	In-app + Push	your-invite-was-used

8. Acceptance Criteria

A feature is complete when all criteria below pass. Each maps to a test case.

AC-SIGNUP-01: Account Creation

- Submitting valid email + strong password creates a User with email_verified=false
- Duplicate email shows login link without confirming whether account uses social sign-in
- Weak password blocks submission and shows strength meter
- Rate limit (5/hour) blocks submission with user-facing message

AC-SIGNUP-02: Email Verification

- Valid token click marks email_verified=true and advances to Step 3
- Expired token shows expiry screen with resend option
- Used token shows appropriate error without revealing token existence
- Resend is blocked for 60 seconds after each send
- Device polling detects verification completed on another device within 10 seconds

AC-SIGNUP-03: Profile Setup

- Display name availability checked in real time (debounced 400ms)
- Taken name shows error inline; does not block typing
- No avatar uploaded → initials avatar generated and stored
- Role selection is required before Continue is enabled
- Role selection correctly sets default subscription_tier on User

AC-SIGNUP-04: Subscription Tier

- Free tier advances without payment flow
- Paid tier shows Stripe Elements inline; disabled Continue until payment succeeds
- Card decline shows Stripe error message; form remains editable
- Pricing rendered from config, not hardcoded

AC-SIGNUP-05: Personality Quiz

- 5 questions render one per screen with back/forward navigation
- Skip stores personality_types=[] on User
- Completed quiz stores exactly 3 selected types on User
- Quiz can be completed later from profile; prompts shown until completed

AC-SIGNUP-06: Circle Discovery

- Recommended Circles shown based on personality_types (or popularity if skipped)
- Invite link entry shows inviting Circle as first card with inviter name
- Joining a Circle creates CircleMember with status=active, role=member
- Joining triggers Circle board notification
- Skip completes onboarding and navigates to home feed
- signup_completed event fires with correct properties

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9. Open Items

ID	Item	Owner	Priority
[OPEN-	Personality type taxonomy and answer-	Product / Data	P0 before Step 5

S01]	to-type mapping algorithm		build
[OPEN-S02]	Subscription pricing ($X Fan, $Y Superfan)	Business	P0 before Step 4 build
[OPEN-S03]	Stripe integration — account setup, webhook config, test keys	Engineering	P0 before Step 4 build
[OPEN-S04]	Social sign-in (Apple, Google) — not in v1	Product	P2 post-launch
[OPEN-S05]	Email template designs (verify, welcome)	Design	P1 before launch
[OPEN-S06]	Analytics system selection (Amplitude, Mixpanel, etc.)	Engineering	P1
[OPEN-S07]	Invite link generation and tracking system	Engineering	P1

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